

Current Affairs Digest – Daily Class Notes

Date: 31 August 2026 | Compiled from live morning current-affairs session | For SSC / Railway / State-level Competitive Exams

1. PM Modi's Central Asia Visit – Uzbekistan & SCO Summit (Kyrgyzstan)

- Central Asia = 5 countries: Kazakhstan, Uzbekistan, Tajikistan, Turkmenistan, Kyrgyzstan.
- PM Modi is the only Indian PM to have visited all five Central Asian nations (in 2015).
- Leg 1: 2-day visit to Uzbekistan (concluded 30 August); Leg 2: Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan for SCO Summit.
- Welcomed in Tashkent (capital of Uzbekistan) by President Shavkat Mirziyoyev.
- Key MoU: Uzbekistan to supply **Uranium** to India for developing **nuclear power**.
- Discussions also held on Uzbekistan's National Yoga Federation, India's GIFT City (Gujarat), and boosting bilateral trade to ~US\$1 billion/year.
- Other focus areas: Trade, Defence, Energy, Digital cooperation.
- Award received: Uzbekistan's highest civilian award – "Order of Dustlik" (Dustlik = friendship; same name as the India–Uzbekistan joint military exercise) – conferred by the President as a "token of friendship".
- PM Modi's total global honours: 36 awards; country-specific highest civilian awards: 35.
- Recent country awards received: Slovakia, Norway, Sweden, Oman, Israel, Ethiopia, Namibia, Brazil, Trinidad & Tobago, Ghana, Cyprus, Sri Lanka, Mauritius, Kuwait.
- Match – Sri Lanka: Mitra Vibhushan; Mauritius: Grand Commander of the Order of the Star and Key of the Indian Ocean; Cyprus: Order of the Cross of Makarios.
- SCO Summit (31 Aug, Bishkek – capital of Kyrgyzstan): 26th edition; SCO HQ – Beijing. Members present include India, Pakistan and newest member Belarus (10th member).

2. Javelin Missiles for Indian Army (USA)

- USA to supply **100 Javelin anti-tank guided missiles** to India; MoA (Memorandum of Agreement) to be signed.
- India had been trying to get these missiles for **17 years**; USA has used them since **1996**.
- Features: man-portable (can be carried on shoulder/bag), medium range (~2.5 km), "Fire and Forget" category, self-locks and hits target automatically.
- Also classified as an Anti-Tank Guided Missile (can destroy tanks).
- Developed jointly by **Raytheon** and **Lockheed Martin** (both USA); deal value: **US\$45.7 million**.
- To be handed over to the Indian Army; 18 countries already use this missile system.
- Recently used by Ukraine against Russia in the ongoing conflict.

3. USA: Lake Ontario to be renamed "Lake America"

- Donald Trump has proposed renaming **Lake Ontario** as "**Lake America**"; Canada has rejected the renaming (will continue calling it Ontario).
- 5 Great Lakes (USA–Canada), remember as **HOMES**: Huron, Ontario, Michigan, Erie, Superior.
- Lake Ontario lies partly in the USA and partly in Canada; the **St. Lawrence River** flows out of it into the **Atlantic Ocean**.
- Earlier precedent: **Gulf of Mexico** renamed "**Gulf of America**" by the USA – also the world's largest gulf.

4. Defence Systems – Quick Match

- **BrahMos** – India & Russia (joint venture); Fire-and-Forget category cruise missile.
- **Iron Dome** – Israel's air defence system.
- **Patriot** missile system – USA.
- **Barak-8** – India & Israel (joint); "Barak" means "Lightning".

5. Elephant Corridors – Tamil Nadu

- 3 new elephant corridors to be built in **Hosur Forest Division, Tamil Nadu** (Tamil Nadu–Karnataka border).
- Purpose: reduce human–elephant conflict as Asian elephants migrate in herds across roads/railway tracks.
- Starting point: **Cauvery (Kaveri) Wildlife Sanctuary**, Tamil Nadu; other locations – Jawalagiri, Jawalagiri-Panai, Bilikkal Jalagiri.
- Madras High Court had earlier directed creation of **41 corridors** in total; work begins with these 3.
- Asian Elephant IUCN status: **Endangered**. Project Elephant launched in **1992**. "Gaj" awards also given for elephant conservation. World Elephant Day: 12 August.

6. Wildlife Sanctuaries – State Match

- Ranthambore – Rajasthan | Periyar – Kerala | Bandipur – Karnataka | Simlipal – Odisha.

7. Hockey World Cup 2026

- Jointly hosted by **Netherlands** and **Belgium**; International Hockey Federation (FIH) HQ – **Lausanne, Switzerland**.
- Women's event (concluded earlier): Winner – **Argentina** (3rd title); Runner-up – Netherlands; 3rd place (bronze) – Belgium.
- Men's event Final: **Germany beat Spain 1-0** (final played in Belgium); Germany's **4th title**, back-to-back.
- India finished **8th**; lost to Belgium in a **shoot-out** after a 3-3 draw. Harmanpreet Singh scored 2 goals for India.

8. Sports Trophies – Quick Match

- Thomas Cup – Badminton | Davis Cup – Tennis | Ranji Trophy – Cricket | Durand Cup – Football (East Bengal won the latest edition).

9. World Sanskrit Day

- Celebrated on **28 August**, coinciding with **Shravan Purnima**; first celebrated in **1969** by the Ministry of

Education.

- Aim: promotion of the Sanskrit language; associated names – Panini (grammarian).
- Focus texts: the four Vedas, Upanishads, Ramayana, Gita. Key Sanskrit scholars: **Aryabhata, Panini, Charaka**.
- India's first Sanskrit newspaper: "**Sudharma**", published from **Mysore**.
- Some states (e.g., Uttarakhand) teach Sanskrit under the **Three-Language Formula** of the National Education Policy.

10. Hindi Diwas

- International Hindi Diwas – **10 January**. National Hindi Diwas – **14 September**.

11. Important Environment Days

- World Wetland Day – 2 February | World Water Day – 22 March | Earth Day – 22 April | World Environment Day – 5 June.

12. National Sports Day – Major Dhyan Chand

- Celebrated on **29 August**, birth anniversary of **Major Dhyan Chand** (born 1905 in Prayagraj/Allahabad).
- Joined the Army in 1922; known as "**The Wizard of Hockey**".
- India won back-to-back Olympic hockey gold medals under his era: **1928 Amsterdam, 1932 Los Angeles, 1936 Berlin**.
- Autobiography titled "**Goal**". He passed away in **1979**.
- Award named after him: earlier **Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna Award** (started 1991-92) → renamed **Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna Award in 2021**.
- He received the **Padma Bhushan in 1956**. **Fit India Movement** launched 2019 under the Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports.
- 2026 theme for National Sports Day: "**Tribute, Play and Move**".
- 2025-26 National Sports Awards: 17 Arjuna Awards announced; no Khel Ratna Award was announced this year.

13. Lokmata Ahilyabai Matrushakti Yojana (Uttar Pradesh)

- Launched by UP CM **Yogi Adityanath**; named after **Ahilyabai Holkar**.
- Provides **lifetime free bus travel** in UP roadways buses (~14,000 buses) for women aged **60 years and above**, verified via Aadhaar.
- Expected to benefit around **1 crore women**. Other recent UP schemes: tablets/laptops for Class 10, 12 & graduation students, scooties for girl students, Swami Vivekanand Yojana.

14. Bihar – Vidya Sathi Scheme

- Launched in Bihar to provide **24x7 free teacher support** to students; expected to benefit around **3 lakh students**.

15. Indian Navy – Multipurpose Vessel "Samarthak"

- New indigenous multipurpose vessel named "**Samarthak**" launched for the Indian Navy – used for underwater survey, search operations, launch platform and patrolling.
- Built by **Larsen & Toubro (L&T)** at **Kattupalli, Chennai**; project started in **2024**; about **75% indigenous** content.
- Predecessor vessel: "**Utkarsh**", launched in 2025, also given to the Indian Navy.
- Other key naval projects to remember: **Project 15B** (destroyers – Visakhapatnam, Mormugao, Surat, Imphal); **Project 75** (Scorpene-class submarines, 6 subs); **Project 17A** (Nilgiri-class frigates – Nilgiri, Dunagiri, Mahendragiri); **Project 75I** (non-nuclear submarines).

16. Indian Railways – Double-Stack Container Train

- First trial of a **double-stack long-distance container train** launched on **21 August**, from **Jawaharlal Nehru Port Terminal, Mumbai** to **Vadodara** (Gujarat).
- Route length approx. **422 km**; load-carrying capacity approx. **392 tonnes**.

17. Chess – R. Praggnanandhaa wins Grand Chess Tour

- **R. Praggnanandhaa** (Grandmaster from Chennai, Tamil Nadu) became the **first Indian** to win the **Grand Chess Tour / Sinquefeld Cup**, held in **St. Louis, USA**; he defeated **Fabiano Caruana**.
- Event organised under **FIDE**; FIDE President – **Viswanathan Anand** (also the first recipient of the Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna Award).
- Other notable Indian Grandmasters: **Divya Deshmukh** (Maharashtra), **Koneru Humpy** (Andhra Pradesh); **D. Gukesh** received the Khel Ratna Award previously.

Current Affairs – MCQ Practice Set

Which country's highest civilian award, the "Order of Dustlik", was recently conferred on PM Modi?

- (a) Kazakhstan (b) Kyrgyzstan (c) Uzbekistan (d) Tajikistan
Ans: (c) Uzbekistan

PM Modi visited all 5 Central Asian countries for the first time in which year?

- (a) 2014 (b) 2015 (c) 2017 (d) 2019
Ans: (b) 2015

The SCO Summit (31 Aug) attended by PM Modi was held in which city?

- (a) Astana (b) Tashkent (c) Bishkek (d) Dushanbe
Ans: (c) Bishkek (Kyrgyzstan)

SCO headquarters is located in which city?

- (a) Beijing (b) Moscow (c) Delhi (d) Shanghai
Ans: (a) Beijing

Which country will supply Uranium to India as per the recent MoU for nuclear power?

- (a) Kazakhstan (b) Uzbekistan (c) Russia (d) Kyrgyzstan

Ans: (b) Uzbekistan

Which country is set to supply 100 Javelin missiles to the Indian Army?

(a) Russia (b) France (c) USA (d) Israel

Ans: (c) USA

Javelin missile is classified under which category?

(a) Surface to Air (b) Fire and Forget (c) Cruise Missile (d) Ballistic Missile

Ans: (b) Fire and Forget

Javelin missile was jointly developed by Raytheon and which other company?

(a) Boeing (b) Lockheed Martin (c) Northrop Grumman (d) BAE Systems

Ans: (b) Lockheed Martin

Which US lake has President Trump proposed to rename as "Lake America"?

(a) Lake Erie (b) Lake Superior (c) Lake Ontario (d) Lake Michigan

Ans: (c) Lake Ontario

The Great Lakes (HOMES) do NOT include which of the following?

(a) Huron (b) Ontario (c) Victoria (d) Superior

Ans: (c) Victoria

Which river flows from Lake Ontario into the Atlantic Ocean?

(a) Mississippi River (b) St. Lawrence River (c) Colorado River (d) Hudson River

Ans: (b) St. Lawrence River

"Iron Dome" air defence system belongs to which country?

(a) USA (b) India (c) Israel (d) Russia

Ans: (c) Israel

BrahMos missile is a joint venture between India and which country?

(a) USA (b) Israel (c) France (d) Russia

Ans: (d) Russia

Barak-8 missile system is a joint venture between India and which country?

(a) Israel (b) USA (c) Russia (d) France

Ans: (a) Israel

Three new elephant corridors are being built in which forest division?

(a) Bandipur (b) Hosur Forest Division (c) Mudumalai (d) Nagarhole

Ans: (b) Hosur Forest Division, Tamil Nadu

As per IUCN status, the Asian Elephant is classified as:

(a) Vulnerable (b) Near Threatened (c) Endangered (d) Critically Endangered

Ans: (c) Endangered

Project Elephant was launched in which year?

(a) 1972 (b) 1985 (c) 1992 (d) 2001

Ans: (c) 1992

Periyar Wildlife Sanctuary is located in which state?

(a) Tamil Nadu (b) Karnataka (c) Kerala (d) Odisha

Ans: (c) Kerala

Similipal Wildlife Sanctuary is located in which state?

(a) Odisha (b) Jharkhand (c) West Bengal (d) Chhattisgarh

Ans: (a) Odisha

Hockey World Cup 2026 was jointly hosted by Netherlands and which country?

(a) Germany (b) Spain (c) Belgium (d) Argentina

Ans: (c) Belgium

Who won the Men's Hockey World Cup 2026 final?

(a) Spain (b) Belgium (c) Netherlands (d) Germany

Ans: (d) Germany (beat Spain 1-0)

India finished at which position in the Men's Hockey World Cup 2026?

(a) 5th (b) 6th (c) 8th (d) 10th

Ans: (c) 8th

Durand Cup is associated with which sport?

(a) Cricket (b) Hockey (c) Football (d) Badminton

Ans: (c) Football

World Sanskrit Day 2026 was celebrated on which date?

(a) 15 August (b) 28 August (c) 29 August (d) 5 September

Ans: (b) 28 August

India's first Sanskrit newspaper "Sudharma" was published from which city?

(a) Varanasi (b) Ujjain (c) Mysore (d) Pune

Ans: (c) Mysore

National Hindi Diwas is celebrated on which date?

(a) 10 January (b) 21 February (c) 14 September (d) 14 November

Ans: (c) 14 September

World Environment Day is observed on:

(a) 22 March (b) 22 April (c) 5 June (d) 2 February

Ans: (c) 5 June

National Sports Day is celebrated on 29 August to mark the birth anniversary of:

(a) Milkha Singh (b) Major Dhyan Chand (c) P.T. Usha (d) Abhinav Bindra

Ans: (b) Major Dhyan Chand

Major Dhyan Chand is popularly known as:

(a) Flying Sikh (b) Wizard of Hockey (c) Bharat Ratna of Sports (d) Hockey King

Ans: (b) Wizard of Hockey

Major Dhyan Chand's autobiography is titled:

(a) Gold (b) Goal (c) Glory (d) Game

Ans: (b) Goal

The Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna Award was renamed as Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna Award in which year?

(a) 2019 (b) 2020 (c) 2021 (d) 2022

Ans: (c) 2021

The theme for National Sports Day 2026 is:

(a) Khelo India, Jeeto India (b) Tribute, Play and Move (c) Fit India Fit Bharat (d) Sports for All

Ans: (b) Tribute, Play and Move

"Lokmata Ahilyabai Matrushakti Yojana" offering lifetime free bus travel for senior women was launched

in which state?

- (a) Madhya Pradesh (b) Uttar Pradesh (c) Bihar (d) Rajasthan

Ans: (b) Uttar Pradesh

The Lokmata Ahilyabai Matrushakti Yojana is named after:

- (a) Rani Lakshmibai (b) Ahilyabai Holkar (c) Savitribai Phule (d) Rani Durgavati

Ans: (b) Ahilyabai Holkar

"Vidya Sathi" scheme providing 24x7 free teacher support was launched in which state?

- (a) Bihar (b) Jharkhand (c) West Bengal (d) Uttar Pradesh

Ans: (a) Bihar

The Indian Navy's newly launched indigenous multipurpose vessel is named:

- (a) Utkarsh (b) Samarthak (c) Sahayak (d) Sagar

Ans: (b) Samarthak

The multipurpose naval vessel "Samarthak" was built by which company?

- (a) Mazagon Dock (b) Cochin Shipyard (c) Larsen & Toubro (d) Garden Reach Shipbuilders

Ans: (c) Larsen & Toubro

"Samarthak" was built at which location?

- (a) Vishakhapatnam (b) Kattupalli, Chennai (c) Kochi (d) Mumbai

Ans: (b) Kattupalli, Chennai

Project 17A relates to which class of naval vessels?

- (a) Destroyers (b) Nilgiri-class Frigates (c) Submarines (d) Aircraft Carriers

Ans: (b) Nilgiri-class Frigates

India's first trial double-stack long-distance container train run started from Mumbai to which city?

- (a) Surat (b) Ahmedabad (c) Vadodara (d) Rajkot

Ans: (c) Vadodara

R. Praggnanandhaa became the first Indian to win which chess tournament held in St. Louis, USA?

- (a) Candidates Tournament (b) World Chess Championship (c) Grand Chess Tour (d) Tata Steel Chess

Ans: (c) Grand Chess Tour

In the Grand Chess Tour final, R. Praggnanandhaa defeated:

- (a) Magnus Carlsen (b) Fabiano Caruana (c) Hikaru Nakamura (d) Ding Liren

Ans: (b) Fabiano Caruana

Who is the current President of FIDE (World Chess Federation)?

- (a) D. Gukesh (b) Viswanathan Anand (c) Arkady Dvorkovich (d) Garry Kasparov

Ans: (b) Viswanathan Anand